

FIRST RENEWAL MEETING · PRE-MEETING CHECKLIST

Five Items to Bring to the First PBM Renewal Meeting. *The First Meeting Sets the Frame.*

Five documents. One internal priority list. One counter-narrative.

This handout names the five items every plan sponsor should walk into the first PBM renewal meeting with. The plan sponsors who walk in with all five negotiate different terms than the plan sponsors who walk in with the PBM's standard renewal deck. The PBM brings a narrative; the plan sponsor that brings these five items brings a counter-narrative.

01 Mid-Year Performance Audit

Actual GER, BER, dispensing fee, rebate-per-claim performance vs. contracted guarantees. Documented gaps where remediation is owed. Mid-year notification record.

This is the W34 Thursday handout, refreshed for the renewal meeting.

02 Definition Variance Document

Side-by-side comparison of high-impact clauses across the past 3-5 contract versions. Highlights of any silent narrowing in rebate definitions, GER methodology, exclusion lists. Estimated dollar impact per change.

This is the W36 Thursday handout, refreshed for the renewal meeting.

03 Disclosure Gap List + Network Configuration Audit + Internal Priority Document

Disclosure Gap List (W31 Thursday handout): which contractually obligated annual disclosures the PBM has actually delivered.

Network Configuration Audit (W29 Thursday handout): per-channel margin and routing pattern vs. contract design.

Internal Priority Document: a one-page summary of what the plan sponsor's benefits committee has prioritized for this renewal cycle. Costs the PBM the option of optimizing for what they want to optimize.



04 The Pattern PBS Sees Most Often

Across approximately 100 PBM contract reviews and audits annually at PBS: the first renewal meeting is the frame-setting meeting. Plan sponsors who walk in with documentation set the frame; plan sponsors who walk in with the PBM's renewal deck inherit the PBM's frame. The deck the PBM brings is engineered. The five items above are the counter-engineering.

05 Paste-Ready: Send to Your Broker or PBM

PRE-MEETING CHECKLIST

Pre-Meeting Document Checklist

- ☐ 1. Mid-Year Performance Audit (W34 Thursday handout, refreshed)
Actual vs. guarantee. Mid-year notification log. Remediation status.
- ☐ 2. Definition Variance Document (W36 Thursday handout, refreshed)
Past 3-5 versions. Drift-by-clause table. Dollar-impact estimates.
- ☐ 3. Disclosure Gap List (W31 Thursday handout)
What was delivered. What was missed. Written request log.
- ☐ 4. Network Configuration Audit (W29 Thursday handout)
Fill distribution by channel. Network exclusion log. Guarantee performance vs. minimum.
- ☐ 5. Internal Priority Document (one page)
Top 3 priorities for this renewal cycle, ranked.
Signed by benefits committee chair.

Meeting Logistics

- ☐ Meeting calendar invite sent to PBM
- ☐ Internal pre-brief held with broker
- ☐ Documentation packet printed and bound
- ☐ Recording / minute-taker assigned
- ☐ Follow-up document expected within ___ business days

06 This Quarter's Action Plan

STEP 1 • THE WEEK BEFORE

Refresh the four prior Thursday handouts with current data

Mid-year audit + definition variance + disclosure gap + network config.

STEP 2 • 3 DAYS BEFORE

Convene the benefits committee

Produce the one-page internal priority document. Get it signed.

STEP 3 • MEETING DAY

Open with the priority document

Frame the conversation around your priorities, not the PBM's renewal deck.

STEP 4 • WITHIN 5 DAYS AFTER

Send the meeting summary in writing

Document what was discussed, what the PBM committed to, and what comes next.